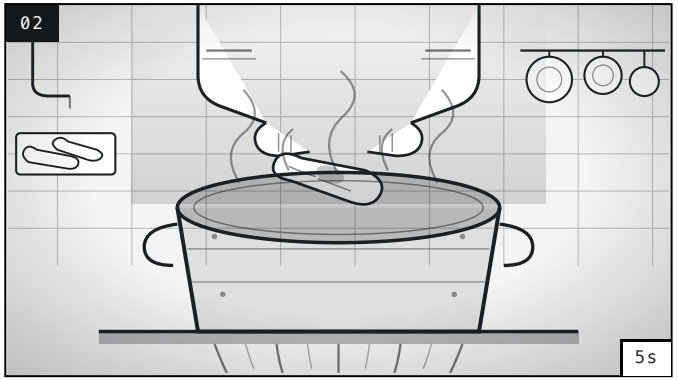
A BOWL OF RAMEN, FOR ME, IS...

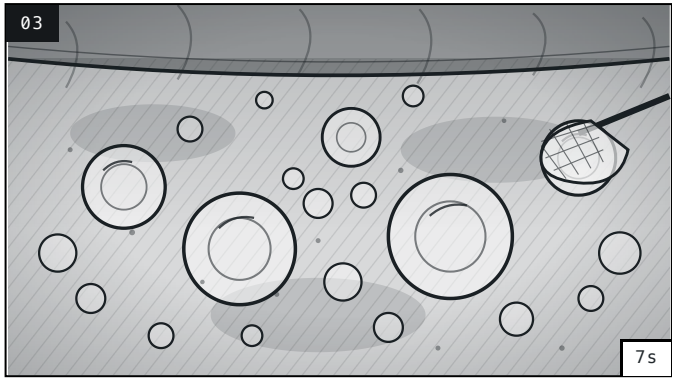
MANPUKU MASCOT — PROMPT-LED SHORT



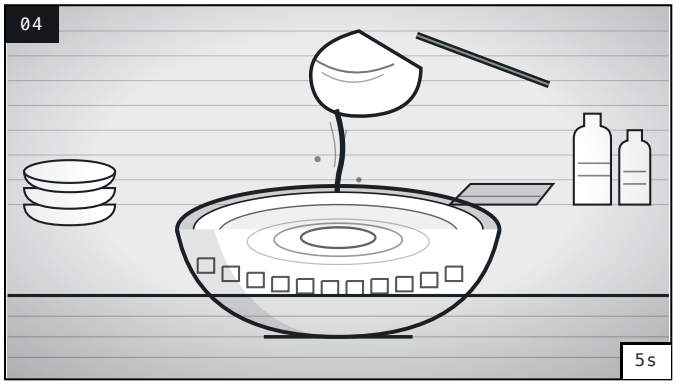
Wide and locked off — the chef alone in the shop at 04:15, half the lights on, before anyone has eaten anything. The prompt sits on screen over this frame.



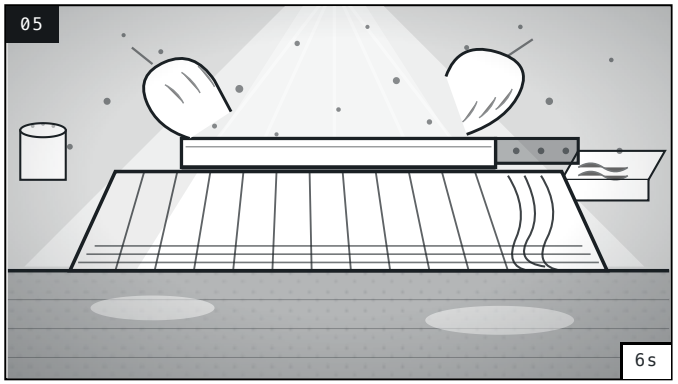
Low angle on the pot rim in the back kitchen as the bones go in. Sync sound only — no music this early.



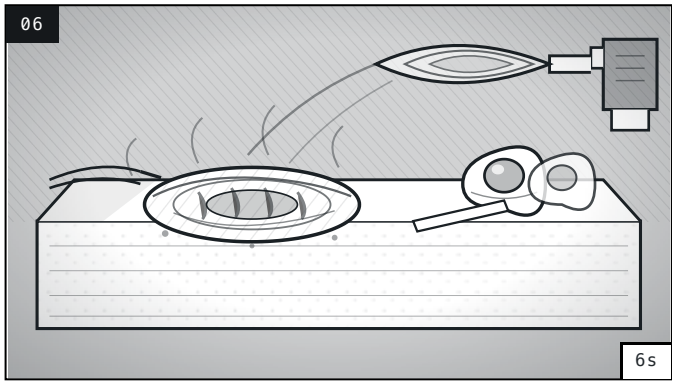
Macro on the surface of the boil, 100mm. Let the glass fog and hold through it — don't wipe, don't cut.



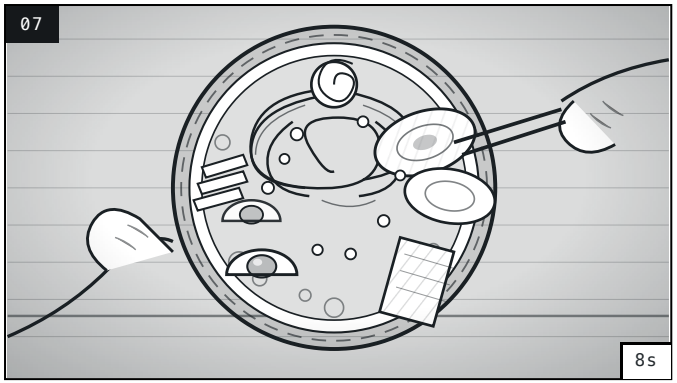
Close on an empty bowl at the pass. The tare goes in first, alone — hold on the ripple before anything else lands.



Hands cutting noodle dough in the noodle room, hard backlight so the flour reads in the air. Cut his answer to the rhythm of the blade, not the other way round.



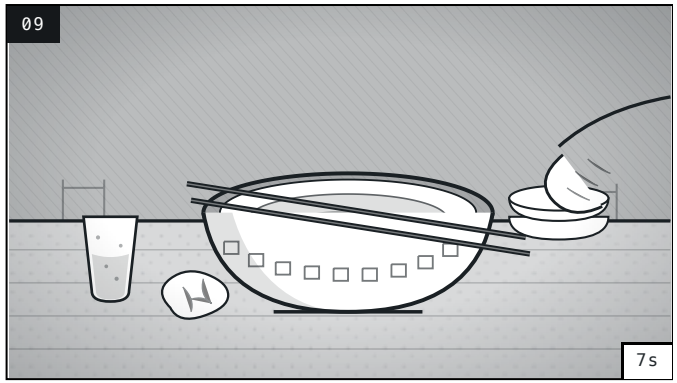
Two hard-lit inserts cut together at the pass — a torch run across the chashu, then the egg opened.



Overhead rig on the pass: the whole bowl built in one unbroken take, hands entering from both sides. No cuts inside the frame.



Over the chef’s shoulder with a soft foreground as the bowl lands at seat 3 — the steam reaches the guest before the bowl does.



Static, no camera move — the empty bowl on the counter at 22:40, chopsticks laid across it. Hold two beats after the hand leaves frame, then cut to black.

THE PROMPTS

A bowl of ramen, for me, is...

OPENS THE FILM · FRAME 01

The best part of a ramen is...

SECOND HALF · FRAMES 06–08

These go on screen as white type over the first frame — three seconds, no voice, nobody reads them aloud. Everything after is him finishing the sentence. A half-sentence gets an honest answer where a question gets a speech. Ask, then stay quiet; the second thing he says is the one you'll use.

ALTERNATE QUESTIONS

Finish this sentence: a bowl of ramen is…	01 · 09
And this one: the best part of a ramen is…	06 · 08
What do people get wrong about ramen?	01
Which part can't be rushed?	02 · 03
What's in the bowl that nobody notices?	04 · 06
What's still hard, after all this time?	05
What do you want someone to feel in the first mouthful?	08
How do you know a bowl was good?	09